

Advance Scout — Andrew Painter (RHP) vs the Atlanta Braves

Philadelphia @ Atlanta · Truist Park · 2026-09-13 · Series Game 3 · vs RHP Grant Holmes

Prepared for: manager / pitching coach / catcher / Painter — advance meeting **Throws:** R · **Arsenal:** 6 pitches (FF, ST, CH, SL, SI, CU) — *one of them did not exist in June* **Governance:** Use Case #44 (uc-pps-030), build dp_uc44 . KPIs inherited verbatim from Baseball Functions.ipynb via dp_uc43_kernel . Seven new governed objects introduced here (SG-1...SG-5, AR-1, PM-1), all provisional. Full trail: Agents for Data Products/data-products/uc-pps-030-painter-vs-braves-001/ .

⚠ Read this first — data window & sample sizes.

- **Entity lock:** `pitcher == 691725` (MLBAM), never a name filter. Resolves to exactly one `player_name` . Opponent starter locked to 656550 (Grant Holmes), confirmed externally, not inferred.
- **Source:** `data/phillies/phils_2026.parquet` , regular season only, current through **2026-09-12** (T-1). 52 spring-training pitches excluded. Target game is D+1.
- **The grading window is the 8 starts since the option** (2026-07-31 → 09-08): **720 pitches, 185 PA**. The 14 starts before it (1,141 pitches, 299 PA) are shown for contrast, **not blended**.
- **Small samples, printed everywhere.** The by-stand, by-pitch cells run 7–131 pitches. Every rate in this report carries its denominator. Nothing below 50 pitches gets a grade; nothing below 25 swings gets a whiff grade. The curveball (16 pitches) is therefore **ungraded**, on purpose.
- **Head-to-head with Atlanta is 47 PA, all of it from April**, and against an arsenal he has since turned over by **33%**. It is history, not evidence.
- **Manual carry-ins from the client, accepted as given and not verified in the log:** the Phillies are three games up on Arizona and one back of the Cubs for the top wild-card seed; Atlanta is out of reach; Holmes starts tonight. None of this is in the parquet.
- **Descoped:** arm-slot analysis. `arm_angle` is null on 54% of the graded window (DQ-6 FAIL). uc-pps-023's arm-spread finding cannot be refreshed on this cache and is not restated here.

Bottom line

1 · Your notecard is right three times, and one of those three is about a pitcher who no longer exists. All three numbers reconcile to the log exactly. But "Plus FS — 39.5% whiff to LHB" is **.395 on 76 swings, every one of them thrown before June 18**. Painter has thrown **zero splitters in eight starts back**. The four-seam line (21.8% whiff, 17.0" of ride) is the *current* pitcher; the splitter line is the one who got optioned.

2 · He replaced the splitter with a changeup, and the changeup is now the best pitch he throws. 22% usage, 90.5 mph (+3.1 on the splitter), 12.8" of arm-side run (+3.0), **.160 xwOBA allowed — a 75 on the results grade**. It misses fewer lefty bats than the splitter did (.301 vs .395) but the gap is **not statistically distinguishable** ($z = 1.20$, $p = 0.23$, 73 vs 76 swings), and it gives up materially less damage (.178 vs .234 xwOBA). This is not a downgrade dressed as a change. The league's splitter usage did **not** fall over the same window (4.1% in June → 5.4% in September, 6 arms throwing 165 of them), so this is a pitcher decision, not a classifier artifact.

3 · The four-seam bought swing-and-miss with strikes, and the bill comes due in pitch count. Elevation rate went .307 → **.349** (population mean .200, sd .076 — a **70** on the elevation grade). Whiff doubled, .106 → .218; **stuff grade 35 → 50**. In-zone rate fell .474 → .422 — **command grade 25**, two and a half standard deviations below the population. That 25 is not wildness: his overall first-pitch-strike rate *improved* (.612 → .638) and his three-ball rate *fell* (.096 → .065). It is a deliberate trade, and it costs him 90 pitches a start for 23 batters.

4 · The platoon has flipped, and Atlanta is built to exploit the new weak side. Post-option he misses **32.2%** of righty swings and **23.8%** of lefty swings ($z = -1.78$, $p = 0.075$ — directional, not significant, so read it as a lean, not a fact). Strikeout rate: **29.7% vs RHH, 18.1% vs LHH**. Of Atlanta's nine most-used bats against Philadelphia this year, **six hit left-handed**.

5 · The Houston start was a home-run start, not a command start — and the fix is a pitch-selection fix against lefties. 27 BF, 6 K, 2 BB, CSW 27.6% (normal for him), but **.438 xwOBA and .550 xwOBACON on 19 tracked balls in play**. Six of eight starts back are under .400 xwOBA; the two that aren't are the only two with multiple home runs. The visible leak: **the sweeper to left-handed hitters —**


```
grade = clip( 50 + 10 × z , 20, 80 ), rounded to the nearest 5
```

Population (SG-2): every right-handed pitcher who threw in a Phillies regular-season game, 2015–2026, with at least 100 pitches of the graded type in that season — Phillies staff *and* every opponent arm that faced them. Pitcher-seasons, not pitchers. Where that yields fewer than 25 pitcher-seasons the floor drops to 50 and the grade is stamped **THIN** (this happens only for the sweeper, n = 29).

This is a Phillies-schedule population, not a league population. Clubs Philadelphia plays often are over-weighted, and an arm that faced them twice counts as much as one that faced them ten times. The grades mean "relative to the arms this club actually sees." They are **not** interchangeable with a Statcast league percentile, and the report never calls them that.

The normality assumption was tested, and it does not hold everywhere. Whiff rate — the input to the stuff grade — passes Shapiro-Wilk at .05 for five of the six graded families (FF .062, CH .108, SL .210, SI .287, CU .277) and **fails for the sweeper (p = .015, skew +0.92)**, which is also the one population that had to drop to the lowered floor. In-zone rate — the input to the command grade — passes for FF (.078), ST (.210), SL (.310) and CU (.059) and **fails for the changeup (p = .006) and the sinker (p < .001)**. Three of the twelve headline grades on the card therefore sit on populations a purist would not z-score.

They are published anyway, for a reason that is checkable rather than convenient: every grade ships with a rank-derived twin (empirical percentile → normal quantile), and **eleven of the twelve headline grades come back identical either way**. The twelfth — slider command — differs by 5 points (z-grade 45, rank-grade 50), which is half the flag threshold. The distributions are skewed; Painter is not standing anywhere the skew matters much. The flag exists for the case where he is, and on this card it never fired.

Shape is reported but not scored. A pitch is worth what it misses and where it lands. Grading velocity, ride and run *into* the pitch grade double-counts the same pitch and makes a beautiful pitch nobody swings through look plus — which is precisely the four-seam's problem, and precisely what this report needs to be able to say.

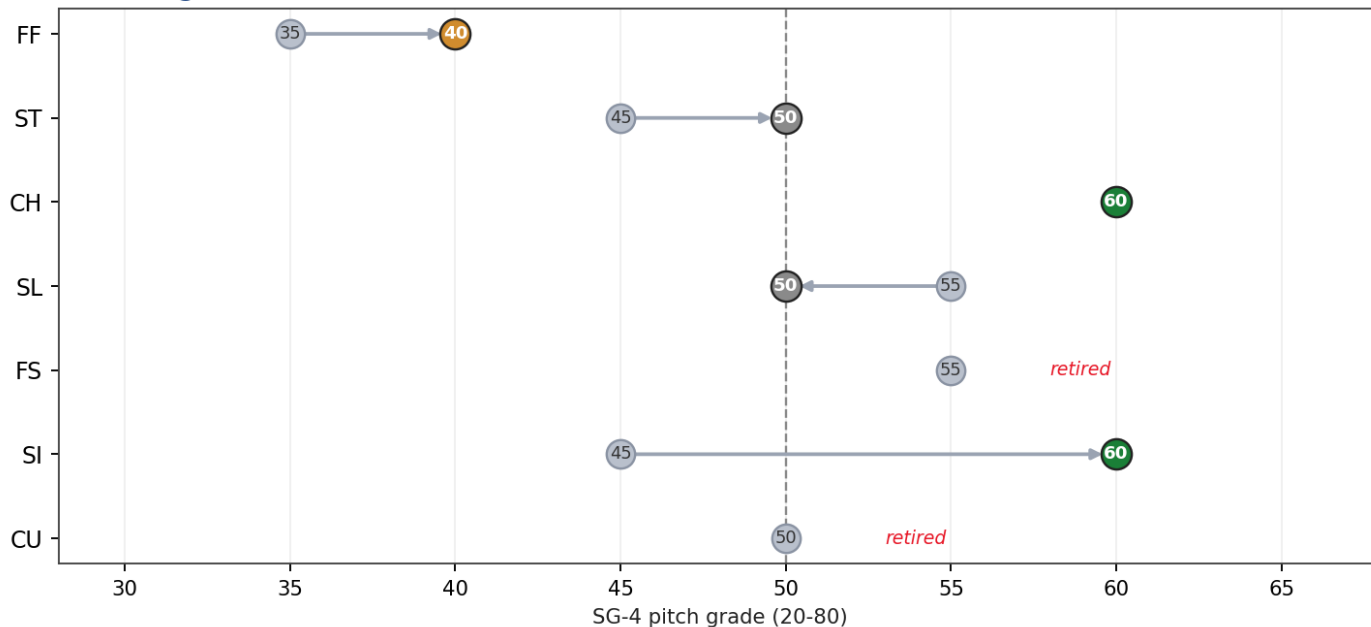
Pitch	n	Usage	Velo	Ride	Run	Whiff	Zone%	xwOBA	Stuff	Cmd	Pitch	Pop n
FF	218	30.3%	96.5	+17.0"	−1.9"	.218	.422	.361	50	25	40	232
ST	178	24.7%	82.5	+1.6"	+17.0"	.304	.506	.304	45	55	50	29 †
CH	160	22.2%	90.5	+5.0"	−12.8"	.346	.406	.160	60	55	60	56
SL	97	13.5%	87.7	+2.8"	+6.8"	.324	.433	.312	50	45	50	92
SI	51	7.1%	95.0	+11.4"	−12.7"	.115	.627	.454	45	70	60	138
CU	16	2.2%	81.8	−9.1"	+8.0"	.286	.438	—	—	—	ungraded	45

† sweeper population is THIN (floor lowered to 50 pitches, n = 29 pitcher-seasons). Its grades are directional.

Arsenal grade: 50, covering 98% of post-option usage — up from **45** on the arsenal that got optioned. Negative plate_x is the third-base side, i.e. inside to a right-handed hitter; this convention is asserted from the data, not assumed.

Pitch-by-pitch, before the option and after arsenal grade 46 → 50

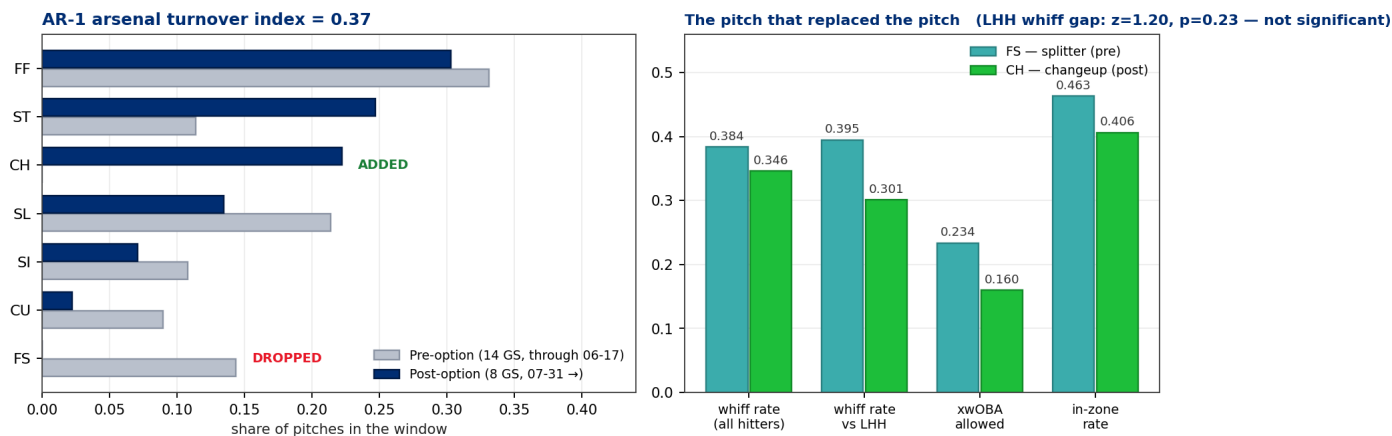
50 = MLB average



Read the movement: the four-seam and the sweeper are the pitches that changed. Everything else is roughly where it was. The splitter simply leaves the chart.

3 · The arsenal turnover (AR-1)

The splitter is gone. What came back is not the same pitch — and is not worse.



AR-1 arsenal turnover index = 0.37. Read it as: about a third of the arsenal on either side of the option date is not shared with the other side.

	Pre-option (14 GS)	Post-option (8 GS)	Δ
FF	33.1%	30.3%	-2.8
ST (sweeper)	11.4%	24.7%	+13.3
CH (changeup)	0.0%	22.2%	ADDED
SL	21.4%	13.5%	-7.9
SI	10.8%	7.1%	-3.7
CU	8.9%	2.2%	-6.7
FS (splitter)	14.4%	0.0%	DROPPED

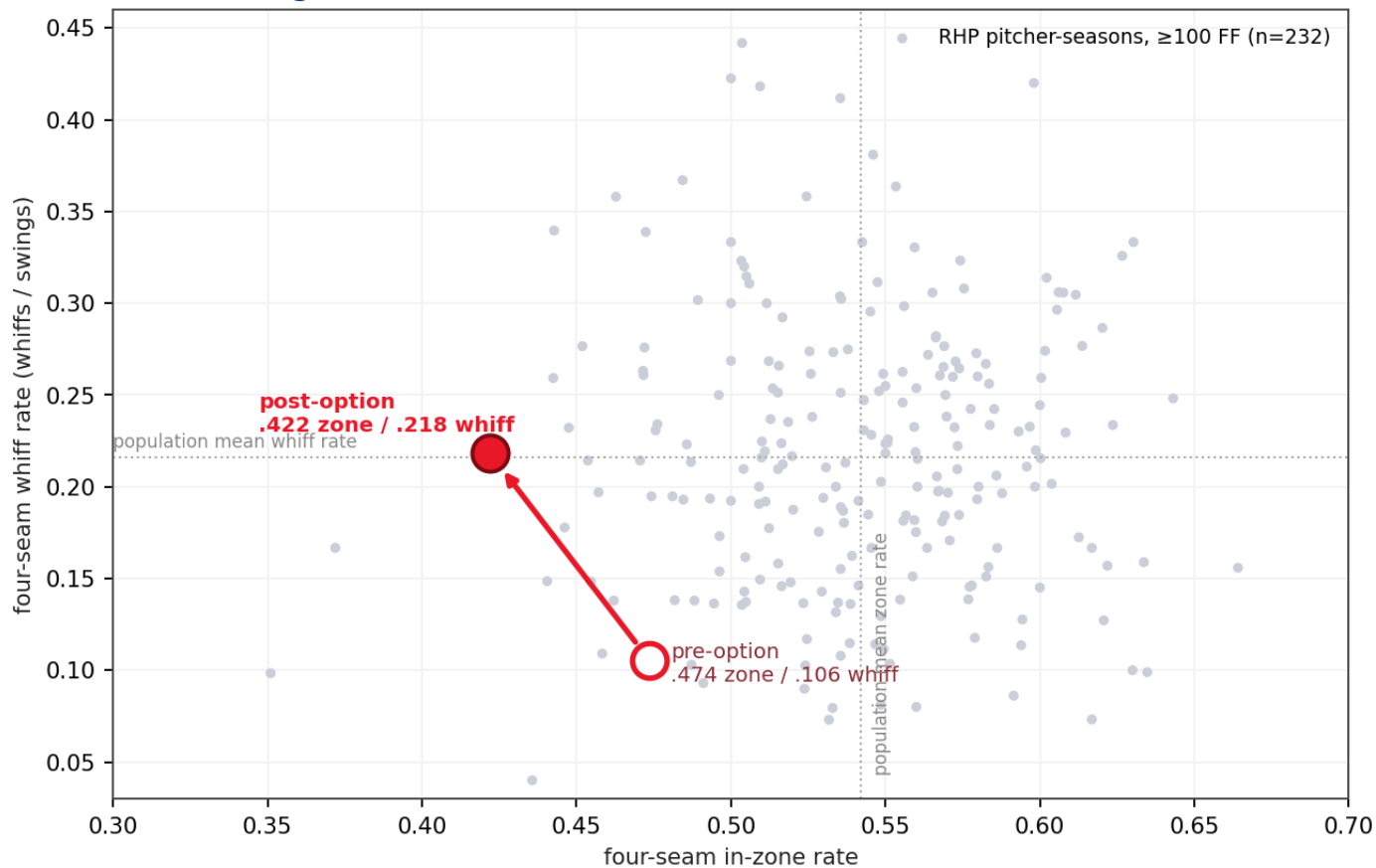
The changeup and the splitter are not the same pitch wearing a different tag. The changeup is **3.1 mph harder, 3.1" flatter, and runs 3.0" more**. Against left-handed hitters it misses fewer bats and allows less damage — and the whiff difference does not clear significance:

	Splitter (pre)	Changeup (post)
Whiff, all hitters	.384 (33/86 sw)	.346 (36/104 sw)
Whiff vs LHH	.395 (30/76 sw)	.301 (22/73 sw)
xwOBA allowed	.234	.160
In-zone rate	.463	.406

$z = 1.20$, $p = 0.23$ on the lefty whiff gap. The honest sentence is: **the lefty weapon was replaced, not lost**. The card's .395 should not be retired from the file — it should be re-dated.

4 · The four-seam trade

Painter moved the four-seam up. It bought a full grade of swing-and-miss and cost a grade and a half of zone.

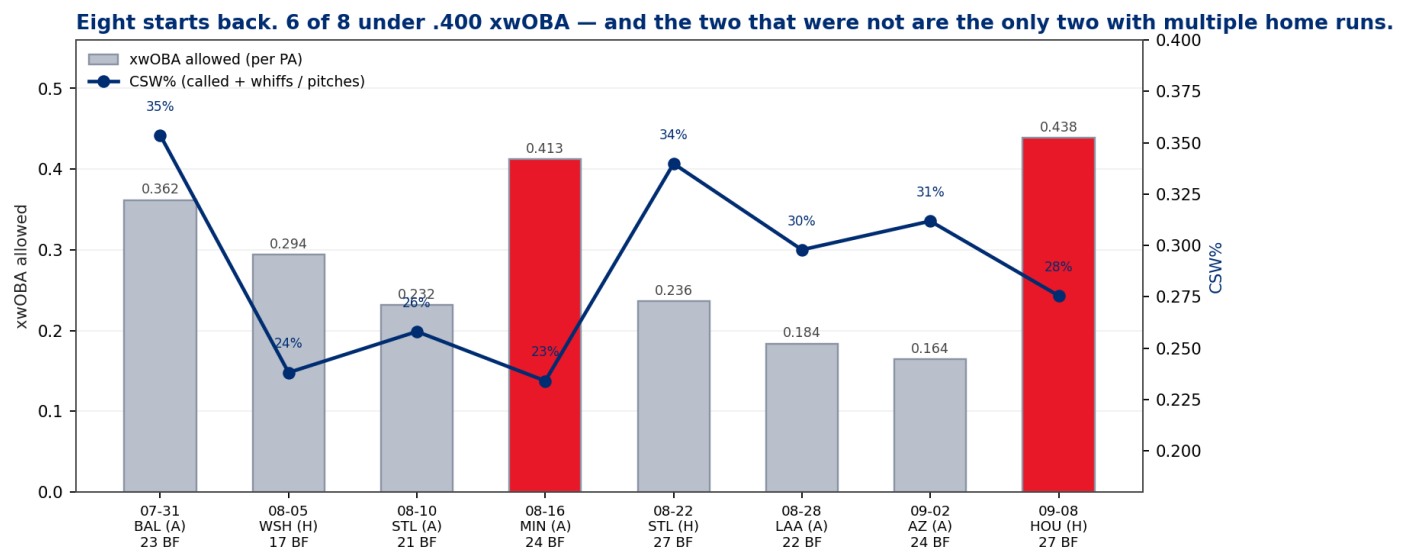


	Pre-option	Post-option	Population (n = 232)
Above the zone	.307	.349	.200 (sd .076) → elevation grade 70
Below the zone	.095	.138	—
In-zone rate	.474	.422	.542 (sd .050) → command grade 25
Whiff	.106	.218	.216 (sd .075) → stuff grade 50
Mean plate_z	2.79 ft	2.75 ft	—

He moved a 96.5 mph, 17"-of-ride four-seam up above the zone and doubled its whiff rate, from a 35 to a 50. The cost is that only 42% of them are strikes, which is a 25. The 25 is the *design*, not a defect — but the design has a price, and the price is **90 pitches for 23 batters a start**, five-and-a-fraction innings when the contact goes badly.

	Pre-option	Post-option
Pitches / BF	3.82	3.89
Pitches / start	81.5	90.0
BF / start	21.4	23.1
First-pitch strike	.612	.638
3-ball count rate	.096	.065

5 · Eight starts back: process vs results



Date	Opp	BF	IP reached	K	BB	HR	CSW	Whiff	xwOBA	xwOBAcon	Hard-hit
07-31	BAL (A)	23	6	6	3	1	.354	.265	.362	.444	8/14
08-05	WSH (H)	17	4	4	1	0	.238	.333	.294	.324	1/11
08-10	STL (A)	21	6	6	3	0	.258	.273	.232	.231	4/12
08-16	MIN (A)	24	5	2	3	2	.234	.143	.413	.392	7/17
08-22	STL (H)	27	7	8	0	0	.340	.333	.236	.336	10/19
08-28	LAA (A)	22	6	6	3	0	.298	.356	.184	.147	3/13
09-02	AZ (A)	24	7	6	0	0	.312	.250	.164	.219	4/18
09-08	HOU (H)	27	5	6	2	2	.276	.264	.438	.550	8/19

The Houston start's strikeout and walk numbers are ordinary for him; its CSW is fifth of eight, inside his own range. What separates it is .550 xwOBA on contact and two home runs. Four of his five post-option home runs came in the two starts where xwOBA cleared .400. One start is evidence, not a verdict — but the evidence points at contact quality, not at command.

All hard-hit counts are hits ≥95 mph over tracked balls in play; both numerators and denominators are printed because untracked BIP would otherwise be silently scored as soft (known defect O-8; exposure this build: 0 of 123).

6 · The matchup — Atlanta

Atlanta's nine most-used bats against Philadelphia pitching this season, 2026 regular season, all Phillies arms:

Bat	S	PA	H	HR	K	Whiff	Chase	xwOBA	vs Painter (H2H)
Ronald Acuña Jr.	R	55	17	4	8	.231	.328	.447	7 PA, 2 H, 1 K
Michael Harris II	L	42	15	3	6	.231	.386	.436	3 PA, 3 H
Austin Riley	R	50	11	4	13	.290	.349	.374	5 PA, 0 H
Drake Baldwin	L	58	14	0	15	.274	.403	.318	5 PA, 0 H, 2 K
Matt Olson	L	54	9	2	10	.277	.306	.312	5 PA, 2 H
Mike Yastrzemski	L	23	7	0	6	.176	.298	.307	5 PA, 1 H
Mauricio Dubón	R	48	10	1	8	.161	.387	.262	5 PA, 1 H, 1 K
Ozzie Albies	L	54	12	0	5	.198	.462	.224	5 PA, 2 H, 1 K
Dominic Smith	L	18	3	1	2	.182	.467	.217	5 PA, 2 H

Six of the nine are left-handed — the side where Painter's whiff rate is 8 points lower and his strikeout rate 12 points lower.

The head-to-head is not usable as a plan. 47 PA across two April starts, maximum 7 PA for any one hitter, and the arsenal turnover between that sample and tonight is **0.33**. Harris II's 3-for-3 is three plate appearances. Every per-hitter line above is **profile-driven, not H2H-driven**, and the H2H column is printed only so nobody re-derives it and believes it.

The exploitable pattern is chase, not damage. Albies (.462), Smith (.467), Dubón (.387), Baldwin (.403) and Harris (.386) all expand. Painter's post-option chase rate is **.387 vs LHH** — higher than vs righties. The changeup below the zone is the pitch that rate is built on.

The single attack rule

Changeup, not sweeper, to the lefties. The changeup allows **.178** xwOBA to LHH on 31% usage. The sweeper to LHH goes in the zone **64.5%** of the time, misses **20.0%** of swings, and has allowed **.523** xwOBA — on 9 tracked plate appearances, which is why this is a usage instruction and not a claim about the pitch.

What each side gets

	vs LHH (94 PA)	vs RHH (91 PA)
Primary	FF 36.3% (.171 whiff, .332 xwOBA)	ST 32.3% (.352 whiff, .214 xwOBA)
Weapon	CH 31.0% (.301 whiff, .178 xwOBA)	CH 13.4% (.452 whiff, .130 xwOBA)
Leak	ST 17.2% (.645 zone, .200 whiff, .523 xwOBA / 9 PA)	SI 12.3% (.087 whiff, .468 xwOBA / 13 PA)
Outcome	.305 xwOBA · 18.1% K · 8.5% BB	.281 xwOBA · 29.7% K · 7.7% BB

The changeup is his best whiff pitch **against right-handers** (.452) and he throws it to them 13% of the time. That is the cheapest available gain in the whole card.

The other half — Grant Holmes

Locked to MLBAM 656550. Philadelphia has seen him **three times this year (260 pitches, 69 PA)** and hit him: **.372 xwOBA allowed**, .317 whiff rate against.

Pitch	n	Usage	vs LHH	vs RHH	Velo	Ride	Run
Slider	100	38.6%	33.5%	47.3%	85.0	-5.2"	+2.2"
4-Seam	90	34.7%	31.7%	39.8%	94.7	+16.0"	-7.7"
Cutter	20	7.7%	11.4%	1.1%	92.0	+11.9"	-0.8"
Curveball	19	7.3%	10.2%	2.2%	83.8	-9.6"	+4.3"
Changeup	17	6.6%	9.6%	1.1%	89.5	+2.2"	-14.0"
Sinker	13	5.0%	3.0%	8.6%	93.7	+6.8"	-16.7"

Against right-handed Phillies bats he is a **two-pitch pitcher — slider and four-seam, 87% of everything**. Against lefties he opens up to five. *Sample caveat: this is Holmes against Philadelphia only. It is not his season profile, and the repo holds no other Holmes data.*

7 · Game-plan takeaways

1. **Lead the lefties with the changeup and the elevated four-seam.** That pair is 67% of what he already throws them and accounts for essentially all of the swing-and-miss on that side.
2. **Cut the sweeper to left-handed hitters.** It is the only pitch in the arsenal he throws into the zone at a 64% clip while missing fewer than a quarter of swings. If it stays, it stays below the zone as a chase pitch, not above it as a strike.
3. **Throw the changeup more to right-handers.** .452 whiff, .130 xwOBA, 13% usage. Acuña and Riley are the two bats in this lineup that have actually damaged Philadelphia pitching; the changeup is the pitch he is currently under-using against them.
4. **Expect 90 pitches for roughly 23 batters.** The elevated four-seam design costs strikes. Plan the bullpen for a five-to-six-inning start, not seven, and do not read a 95-pitch fifth inning as a warning sign — it is the design working as intended.
5. **Do not re-run the April head-to-head.** 47 PA against an arsenal that is a third different. If anyone asks for Painter-vs-Acuña, the answer is 7 PA and the splitter he no longer throws.
6. **The Houston start does not change the plan.** Its process was normal; its contact quality was not. One start of .550 xwOBAcon is a data point about batted balls, not a diagnosis.

8 · Candid data-window & freshness caveats

- **The whole grading window is 185 plate appearances.** That is below the repo's 100-BF floor only in the by-pitch, by-stand cells — which is why those cells print denominators and why three of them (ST vs LHH at 9 tracked PA, SI vs RHH at 13, SL vs LHH at 7) are flagged in-line rather than converted into grades.
- **The platoon split is a lean, not a fact.** $z = -1.78$, $p = 0.075$. It is reported because it aligns with a mechanism (the lefty weapon changed) and with the lineup Atlanta will run. It would not survive as a standalone claim.
- **The sweeper grades are THIN.** Population $n = 29$ pitcher-seasons at a lowered floor. Read them as ± 1 grade.
- **The benchmark is a Phillies-schedule population**, not a league one. A 60 here is not a Savant 60.
- **Arm-slot analysis is descoped.** `arm_angle` is null on 54% of the graded window. The uc-pps-023 arm-spread finding (13.8° vs a 4.25° pool median) is **not** refreshed here and should not be assumed to still hold.
- **release_extension is null on 1 of 720 pitches** and excluded from the mean rather than imputed.
- **One truncated_pa** sits in the graded window and is counted as a plate appearance by the governed `get_stats` (known defect O-5). Effect on any published rate: under one part in 185.
- **Standings, probable starters and lineup are carry-ins from the client.** Nothing in the parquet confirms who starts tonight or where anyone sits in the wild-card race.
- **AAA is not blended.** Painter's Lehigh Valley rows were loaded unweighted and used for context only; no MLB rate in this report contains a minor-league pitch.

Artifacts: build `dp_uc44Painter_vs_braves.py` · kernel `dp_uc44_kernel.py` · figures `dp_uc44_build_figs.py` · dashboard `dp_uc44Painter_scouting_card.html` · 21 CSV receipts + payload in `out/` · verification `dp_uc44_verification.py` · governance trail 00 — 07 .

Closure step: post-game backtest — projected attack plan vs actual pitch mix and results, eight checks, specified at 07_platform_marketing.md §4. A single start records evidence, not a verdict.